5. Petitions against police for refusing to register a case, harassment by police and death in police custody

6. Petitions against atrocities on women, in particular harassment of bride, bride-burning, rape, murder, kidnapping, etc.

7. Petitions complaining of harassment or torture of villagers by co-villagers or by police from persons belonging to Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribes and economically backward classes

8. Petitions pertaining to environmental pollution, disturbance of ecological balance, drugs, food adulteration, maintenance of heritage and culture, antiques, forest and wild life and other matters of public importance

9. Petitions from riot-victims

10. Family pension

The cases falling under the following categories will not be entertained as PIL:

1. Landlord–tenant matters

2. Service matter and those pertaining to pension and gratuity

3. Complaints against Central/State Government departments and Local Bodies except those relating to item numbers (1) to (10) above

4. Admission to medical and other educational institution

5. Petitions for early hearing of cases pending in High Courts and Subordinate Courts

PRINCIPLES OF PIL

The Supreme Court evolved the following principles in regard to PIL[2]:

1. The Court in exercise of powers under Articles 32 and 226 of the Constitution can entertain a petition filed by any interested person in the welfare of the people who are in a disadvantaged position and thus not in a position to knock the doors of the Court. The Court is constitutionally bound to protect the Fundamental Rights of such disadvantaged people and direct the State to fulfil its constitutional promises.

2. When the issues of public importance, enforcement of the fundamental rights of large number of people vis-à-vis the constitutional duties and functions of the State are raised, the court treat a letter or a telegram as a PIL. In such cases, the court relaxes the procedural laws and also the law relating to pleadings.

3. Whenever injustice is meted out to a large number of people, the court will not hesitate to step in to invoke Articles 14 and 21 of the Constitution of India as well as the International Conventions on Human Rights which provide for a reasonable and fair trial.

4. The common rule of *locus standi* is relaxed so as to enable the court to look into the grievances complained on behalf of the poor, deprived, illiterate and the disabled who cannot vindicate the legal wrong or legal injury caused to them for violation of any constitutional or legal right.